प्रधान आयुक्त सीमा शुल्क (आयात) का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE PR. COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS (IMPORT),
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Date: 09.03.2026

MINUTES OF THE PERMANENT TRADE FACILITATION COMMITTEE MEETING HELD ON 27.02.2026

The second meeting of Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee (PTFC), for the month of February 2026 was held in the Conference Hall of ACC at 03:00 PM on 27.02.2026 and was chaired by Shri Manish Chandra, Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) and co-chaired by Shri Hardeep Batra, Commissioner of Customs (Export). The following officers and representatives participated in the meeting:

Sl. No.	Name & Designation (Customs)	Organization
1	Shri Neelesh Rautkar, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
2	Shri Tagadi Manjunath, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
3	Shri N Pandiyaraj, Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
4	Shri G.L Narsimham, Joint Commissioner (In-Situ), (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
5	Shri Kanhaiya Poddar, Deputy Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
6	Shri Gautam Shelare, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
7	Shri M. Sree Harsha, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
8	Shri Rajesh Solanki, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
9	Shri Itha Ramalingeshwara Rao, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

10	Shri Kiran Vasant Vaidya, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
11	Shri Deepak Kumar Singh, Superintendent, (Import, Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
12	Shri Amrinder Sandhu, Superintendent, (Export, E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
13	Shri Shashank Shekhar, Examiner, (Import, Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
14	Shri Parveen Kumar, Examiner (Export, E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
15	Shri Sourav Kumar, Examiner, (Import, Technical)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

Sl. no.	**Name of attendees of Stakeholders**	**Organization**
1	Shri Ketan Desai, Secretary	BCBA
2	Shri Kaushal Thakkar, Import Chairman	BCBA
3	Shri Dushyant Mulani, Chairman	BCBA
4	Shri Shailesh Sharma, Secretary	ACAAI
5	Shri Rajen Bhatia, Chairman	ACAAI
6	Shri Vishal V. Kamble, Dy. Manager	MIAL Security
7	Shri Naresh Kumar, Deputy Manager	MIAL
8	Shri Gaurav Sabnis, Assistant Manager	MIAL
9	Shri Vikas Korgaonkar, Associate Manager	MIAL
10	Shri Parshuram Upadhyay, Secretary	CSC
11	Shri Subodh Thakur, Manager	MASCPL
12	Shri Praveen A. Jagtap, ADC	CDSCO
13	Shri Kadam J.B., Technical Officer	FSSAI
14	Shri Tushar Dabholkar, Manager	China Airlines
15	Shri Nischal D'Souza, Dy. Manager	Import

The Principal Commissioner of Customs welcomed all the attendees. The following agenda points were taken up for discussion and decision: -

Open Points from the last PTFC meeting:

1. **Frequent breakdown of CARR message between Customs and Custodian**

BCBA has observed that the CARR message exchange system between Customs and Custodians is frequently non-functional, at least twice a week, leading to delays in export clearances.

Discussion and Decision:

BCBA Representative, Shri Kaushal Thakkar informed that Ms. Chaitaly Mehta is dealing with this issue and was not available to attend this meeting.

The factual report shall be submitted in the next PTFC Meeting.

Point Closed
Action: BCBA

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2. **Issuance of MIAL passes without insistence on Police Verification**

BCBA informed that while applying for MIAL passes, MIAL is insisting on Police Verification. BCBA submits that the applicants are holders of valid Customs passes of F, G, and H categories, which are issued after due Police Verification by the Customs Department and are valid for a lifetime.

BCBA requested that Police Verification may not be insisted upon for applicants who are already Customs pass holders, and that MIAL passes may also be issued with lifetime validity in line with their Customs passes.

Discussion and Decision:

BCBA Representative, Shri Ketan Desai, stated that Customs Passes are issued only after Police verification. Therefore, no additional NOC from the Police should be required for MIAL passes.

MIAL Representative, Shri Vikas Korgaonkar, Associate Manager informed that they are adhering to BCAS guidelines, which mandate an NOC from the Police for MIAL passes.

[POST MEETING COMMENT – Shri Amit Kadam, Asst. Manager, MIAL, in his email dated 26.02.2026 has said that Cargo Entry Permits Are Governed by Airport Security Requirements, Cargo Entry Permits fall under the management of the airport operator's internal access-control system, driven by:

- the current aviation-security threat environment,
- the Aerodrome Security Program approved for the airport,

- insider-threat mitigation norms, and
- the need to maintain strict control over access to operational cargo areas that interface with aircraft operations.

Therefore, Cargo Entry Permit remain subject to airport-level aviation-security risk assessment.

Customs Pass Verification and Airport Verification Serve Different Security Objectives.

Cargo Entry Permits Cannot Be Lifetime.

Airport security operates in a dynamic threat environment, requiring periodic:

- review of access credentials,
- updating of employee records, and
- reassessment of security-related background checks.

Police Verification Is Essential and Cannot Be Waived.**]**

Principal Commissioner said that BCAS will be asked for their comments.

Point Closed
Action: Import Commissionerate

New Agenda Points:

1. **Public Notice for Protest Registration Number (ICEGATE Advisory dated 17.02.2025)**

BCBA requested issuance of a suitable Public Notice detailing the procedure for obtaining the "Customs House Protest Registration Number" for the purpose of filing online refund claims pursuant to the ICEGATE Advisory dated 17.02.2025.

BCBA highlighted that the trade is presently unaware of the prescribed procedure for obtaining the Protest Registration Number from the Department and stated that a clear Public Notice outlining the step-by-step process would facilitate compliance and avoid unnecessary delays in filing refund claims.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner stated that the matter will be considered.

Point Closed
Action: Import Commissionerate

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2. A) Difficulty in Clearance of RMS Consignments Arriving in Part

BCBA highlighted that Importers are facing significant hardship and incurring heavy demurrage charges when RMS consignments arrive in parts and are placed on hold. It was informed that the following two situations are being encountered:

i) Part clearance of RMS Bill of Entry before Out of Charge (OOC), and
ii) Part clearance of RMS Bill of Entry after OOC

Due to procedural constraints, consignments are held up despite being facilitated under RMS. The trade has reported that such delays are being experienced particularly at ACC, Mumbai, whereas similar issues were not faced earlier.

BCBA has requested that a suitable mechanism be evolved to address both scenarios so that importers are not burdened with demurrage for reasons beyond their control.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner reminded that this matter has already been discussed and reiterated that the provision is not permissible under ICES. DG Systems has been requested to enable the System for Part Clearance. BCBA was informed about this in letter vide F.No. GEN/TECH/Misc/1532/2025-PRO-O/o Commr-Cus-Imp-Zone-III-Mumbai dated 04.02.2026. In all such cases of short landing which require IGM amendment, it is not possible to allow part clearances.

BCBA representative, Shri Dushyant Mulani informed that such facility is available at Delhi Airport and cited a Public Notice issued by Nhava Sheva for clearance of part consignments.

Principal Commissioner advised to share the details and also reiterated that DG Systems has to take up action in this regard.

Point Closed

B) Clearance of INTO-BOND Bills of Entry Pending PGA NOC

BCBA has requested reconsideration of the issue pertaining to clearance of INTO-BOND Bills of Entry where PGA NOC is pending but bonding of goods has been permitted. This facility is currently not being extended at ACC, Mumbai, though it is available at other ports, where Public Notices have also been issued to support trade facilitation and reduce delays.

BCBA highlighted that Non-availability of this facility at ACC, Mumbai is resulting in heavy demurrage costs to importers and requested restoration of the earlier practice of allowing such clearances as a measure of trade facilitation and in line with the objective of ease of doing business.

Discussion and Decision:

Principal Commissioner stated that this issue had been discussed previously. This office is adhering to the Board's instructions dated 26.02.2016, (F. No. 450/14/2015-CUS-IV) which was reiterated by citing the High Court judgement dated 24.04.2024 in the case of CRR 819 of 2019 (M/s. Flemingo Duty Free Shop Pvt. Ltd. and Ors. Vs. Shri Kaushik Bhattacharya & Anr.) In case of such imported goods, in respect of which it is not feasible for the PGA to issue an NOC immediately, such goods may be allowed the facility under Section 49 of the Customs Act, 1962.

Point Closed
Action: Import Commissionerate

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3. <u>Deployment of Adequate Manpower in Docking Area</u>

BCBA has requested that MIAL/Adani increase manpower for regulating vehicular movement within the docking area. BCBA highlighted that the present situation is highly congested and poses serious safety risks, and emphasized that immediate corrective measures are necessary to prevent any potential life-threatening incidents.

Discussion and Decision:

MIAL representative Shri Gaurav Sabnis, informed that adequate manpower is deployed throughout the day to ensure cargo delivery on time.

BCBA representative Shri Dushyant Mulani, stated that during the closing of the financial year, there will be a surge in trade volumes. Hence, more supervision is required from Hotel ITC Maratha for speeding up of traffic movements which would help in reducing the clearance time.

MIAL representative, Shri Gaurav Sabnis informed that there is a constant monitoring of traffic movement from Hotel ITC Maratha to Cargo Complex. The forklift and manpower deployment are increased on Mondays to ensure quick movement of goods. He also raised the issue of Agents (Custom Brokers) coming very late at night to take delivery which leads to delay.

Principal Commissioner advised BCBA and MIAL to meet before the next PTFC for coming up with solutions/suggestions to handle the vehicular movement issues.

Point Open
Action: BCBA & MIAL

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4. <u>Mandatory Entry of Vehicles with Cleaner</u>

BCBA has requested that MIAL/Adani make it mandatory for vehicles entering the Cargo Complex to be accompanied by a cleaner. This would ease the burden on drivers while accessing docking areas, improve operational efficiency, and ensure smoother cargo movement.

Discussion and Decision:

MIAL Representative, Shri Gaurav Sabnis informed that Cleaners are not allowed to accompany the Driver while entering the ACC/Ports.

[Shri Amit Kadam, Asst. Manager, MIAL in his email dated 26.02.2026 has said that Cleaners are not allowed to accompany the Driver while entering the ACC/Ports.]

Commissioner (Export) stated that the general practice is that whenever there are heavy vehicles, there has to be one assistant with the driver to guide him to manoeuvre.

Principal Commissioner said that MIAL may allow Cleaners subject to the same Checks and Passes applicable for Drivers. He suggested MIAL to take this issue up with higher authorities and inform of the outcome in the next PTFC Meeting.

Point Open
Action: MIAL

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5. <u>Poor Infrastructure Conditions at Air India Warehouse</u>

BCBA has highlighted serious concerns regarding the Air India warehouse and pointed out the following issues:

a) Damaged Docking Surface: The broken and uneven surface poses a high risk of accidents during loading and unloading. Immediate repairs are required.

b) Inadequate Lighting: The warehouse remains poorly lit even during daytime. Proper lighting fixtures need to be installed urgently to ensure safe and efficient operations.

c) Non-functional Fans/Exhaust Systems: Functional fans and exhaust systems are urgently required to maintain proper ventilation within the warehouse.

Discussion and Decision:

ADC (I), Shri Tagadi Manjunath informed that the issues raised by BCBA regarding poor infrastructure conditions at Air India Warehouse have also been highlighted by Shed officers.

Shri Hiren Joshi, AIASL representative, acknowledged the infrastructure issues and stated that remedial work is underway, including installation of extra lighting and fans.

On being asked by the Principal Commissioner about the timeline for completion, Shri Hiren Joshi informed that these infrastructure issues would be resolved within one month.

Point Closed

Action: AIASL

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6. <u>Delay in Issuance of NOC from PGA – Drug Controller Office & AQ due to SWIFT 2.0 Issues</u>

BCBA has highlighted that there is a recurring delay in obtaining NOC from the PGA – Drug Controller Office (CDSCO) and AQ authorities. BCBA informed that in several cases, complete Bill of Entry details are not visible in the system, particularly where the number of line items is high, reportedly after implementation of SWIFT 2.0 by ICEGATE.

BCBA stated that due to this technical difficulty, Bills of Entry are either not visible or only partially visible to PGA officers, resulting in delays in processing and issuance of NOC, leading to demurrage, detention charges, and hardship to the trade.

BCBA has requested that the matter be taken up with the concerned authorities and ICEGATE technical team for early resolution. In the interim, suitable alternative arrangements or manual intervention may be permitted to avoid disruption in clearance.

Discussion and Decision:

BCBA representative Shri Dushyant Mulani, clarified that the issue is not attributable to the ADC Office but has arisen because of SWIFT 2.0. He explained that earlier, a single NOC could be issued for a Bill of Entry even if it had multiple items. However, under SWIFT 2.0, a separate NOC is required for each item in the Bill of Entry, which has increased the time and workload significantly.

Principal Commissioner informed that the matter will be escalated to DG Systems for resolution/advice.

Point Closed

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7. <u>Systems Issue for BOE Amendments under Section 18A</u>

BCBA has highlighted that the trade is facing practical difficulties in processing amendments under Section 18A on the ICEGATE Portal due to system constraints, resulting in delays and hardship.

BCBA informed that earlier, similar cases were permitted to be amended manually under Section 149. In view of genuine difficulties, particularly for importers seeking to complete duty payments before the financial year-end, it is requested that manual amendments be allowed in deserving cases to prevent revenue loss and operational bottlenecks.

BCBA further suggested that amendments under Section 149 may be read in conjunction with Section 18A, and no penalty be imposed where delays arise due to system limitations rather than importer's fault. Suitable procedural relief is requested to facilitate clearance and timely duty payment.

Discussion and Decision:

BCBA representative Shri Dushyant Mulani stated that in some cases, amendments under Section 18A cannot be filed online due to system glitches. He suggested that the earlier practice of allowing manual amendments, followed by updation in the system, may be considered. He also requested that Sections 149 and 18A be applied together so that no penalty is imposed where voluntary payments are made but GST credit does not reflect due to technical issues.

Principal Commissioner enquired about the status of applications under Section 18A and was informed that applications have been filed. It was clarified that such applications must be submitted through the importer's login using a valid digital signature.

Principal Commissioner advised that details of all pending cases, along with proof of attempts made through the importer's login and Helpdesk Complaint Ticket Nos. be submitted for examination.

Point Closed
Action: BCBA

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8. <u>Issues relating to selecting correct document title and Drug category qualifiers while filing BoEs pertaining to CDSCO</u>

ADC/CDSCO, Shri Praveen A. Jagtap highlighted concerns regarding the recently implemented ICEGATE 2 (SWIFT 2.0) module for CDSCO. It is observed that while uploading mandatory documents (Import License of Drugs, MD-15 for medical

device, Registration Certificate in Form 41 etc.), the correct document type is often not selected, resulting in higher scrutiny time.

ADC/CDSCO further informed that under these mandatory license titles, irrelevant documents like AWB, COA., Invoices, etc are being uploaded. The list of document and Drug related category qualifiers have been published vide Public Notice No. 73/2025-26 dated 10.02.2026 by Principal Commissioner of Customs (Imports), ACC, Mumbai.

Discussion and Decision:

ADC (I), Shri Tagadi Manjunath suggested BCBA to sensitize their partners in this matter.

BCBA Representative Shri Ketan Desai informed that the issue has already been taken up with the SWIFT Team, as in some cases documents uploaded through e-Sanchit are not visible on CDSCO officers' screens due to technical issues.

Principal Commissioner observed that the quality of import declarations needs to improve. BCBA acknowledged that both documentation lapses and technical glitches are contributing to delays and assured that a circular would be issued to all members in this regard.

Point Closed

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9. <u>Request to Stakeholder to timely raise concerns to ICEGATE helpdesk to resolve any errors or issues</u>

ADC/CDSCO, Shri Praveen A. Jagtap has requested stakeholders to promptly report any concerns, errors, or system-related issues to the ICEGATE Helpdesk as and when they are encountered.

ADC/CDSCO informed that since SWIFT 2.0 is currently in the initial phase of implementation, timely reporting of difficulties faced during filing will assist the authorities in resolving issues expeditiously and improving system functionality.

Discussion and Decision:

ADC/CDSCO Shri Praveen A. Jagtap stated that many system-related complaints are being received in their office and clarified that such technical issues must be addressed at the System level. He advised BCBA members to raise tickets directly with the ICEGATE Helpdesk and, where necessary, escalate the matter through the designated WhatsApp groups with DG Systems and the Infosys development team for timely resolution.

Point Closed

Action: BCBA

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10. <u>Non-availability of Scanning Facility in Air India Shed</u>

It was noted during the discussion that there are presently no plans to install a scanning machine at the Air India Shed. Shed DC, Shri Kanhaiya Poddar expressed concern that, in the absence of scanning facilities, cargo may have to be shifted from Air India to MIAL.

Principal Commissioner emphasized that every Shed should be equipped with appropriate scanning infrastructure and enquired whether the type of Scanner required could be identified and specified. Shed AC confirmed that the same could be identified and proposed accordingly.

Point Open
Action: Import Commissionerate

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11. Action to be taken on Installation of a Gate Scanner for Oversized Cargo:

CSC representative Shri Parshuram Upadhyay, Secretary, informed that enquiries were made with major airports such as Bengaluru and Hyderabad, and it was confirmed that no such gate scanner facility presently exists there. He stated that only 180 x 180 Scanners are available, which are among the largest currently in use. He further informed that the matter would be reviewed internally and that confirmation would also be obtained from other airports like Kolkata and Delhi.

ACCAI representative Shri Shailesh Sharma clarified that the request is not specifically for a gate scanner, but for a larger scanning facility capable of handling oversized cargo, especially for freighter aircraft. It was pointed out that due to size limitations of existing scanners, large export consignments, including machinery, are required to be opened for physical examination, resulting in repacking issues, damage complaints, flight delays, and additional costs.

Principal Commissioner observed that no Air Cargo Complex in the country presently has such a facility and advised the Trade Associations to submit a formal written representation indicating the volumes of their oversized cargo processed at ACC INBOM4. The matter would then be taken up at the appropriate policy level for further consideration.

Point Open
Action: ACAAI

The meeting ended after the foregoing discussions.

This issues with the approval of the Principal Commissioner of Customs, Import, ACC, Mumbai.

T. 9/3/2026

(Tagadi Manjunath)
Additional Commissioner of Customs,
Import, ACC, Mumbai - III

Copy:
1. Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
2. All Addl./JC Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General/Pr.CCO, ACC.
3. All members of PTFC including BCBA & ACAAI (via e-mail).
4. DC/EDI for uploading on ACC website (via e-mail).
5. PGAs, ACC Mumbai (via e-mail).
6. Office copy.